

EXECUTIVE SUMMARY

Communications

The **City of Chicago** signed a 10-year, **\$32.5 million contract** with **Illinois Bell** to upgrade the city's telecommunications network. The project will **integrate 500 city government locations on one network**.

The **Chicago Board of Trade** is holding talks with the **London International Financial Futures Exchange** about **hooking up their trading systems**. Both exchanges are developing trading systems which use similar technologies.

E-Mail

Users of **AT&T Mail** in the U.S. and electronic-mail services in France and Japan **can exchange messages via an X.400-based AT&T interconnection called AT&T Gateway400 Service**. The service connects AT&T Mail to Transpac's Atlas 400 in France and KDD's Messavia in Japan.

The **FCC approved Pacific Bell's request** to offer an electronic-mail and messaging service. PacBell's Connection has been **tested by Santa Clara University's Master of Business Administration Program to exchange class notes, send messages, and submit papers**. PacBell plans to offer the service to the general public by midyear.

RBOCs

The **Washington Utilities and Transportation Commission** has filed a complaint against **US West Communications** alleging that the **company may be earning excessive profits**. The commission, which conducted an extensive review of US West's financial records, will **launch an investigation of the company's revenues and expenses**.

The **New York Public Service Commission** ordered **Nynex** to provide **central office connections to competitors in exchange for flexibility in private-line pricing** in metropolitan New York City. Nynex must provide interconnections to companies such as Teleport Communications Group, a local private-line service provider that has a fiber-optic network in Manhattan.

Northern Telecom signed an agreement with **Nynex Business Information Systems** under which **Nynex will distribute Northern Telecom's Meridian Norstar digital key system**. Nynex will market the Meridian Norstar to customers through its New England and New York sales offices.

Telecommunications

Phone systems are as vulnerable to break-ins as computer networks, warns **Al Burgess**, managing partner of the **Telecom Industry Group at Andersen Consulting**. "Today's telephone networks are designed for efficiency and ease-of-use, first, then security," he says.

Fiber Optics

Nynex signed a contract with **Raynet** for a one-year trial of Raynet's "fiber-to-the-curb" system, which **delivers fiber-optic cable service to homes and businesses**. Nynex has started to install the system on a trial basis in 100 homes in Lynnfield, Mass. Bell of Pennsylvania, a Bell Atlantic company, also has begun a fiber-to-home trial in Perryopolis, Pa.

AT&T

The **FCC approved AT&T's MultiQuest service**, which introduces an **interactive service via a 900 telephone number assigned to a customer**. Unlike the current 900 service, which is "one-way" only, MultiQuest will provide multiple, simultaneous interactive communications. Charges will vary from 75 cents to \$2 per minute.

FTS 2000

The government **dismissed MCI's protest over AT&T's FTS 2000 contract award**. The GSA Board of Appeals said that MCI did not have a right to file a protest because it was **not a primary bidder**.

Network Management

Cincom introduced **Network Navigator**, which allows users to distribute PC software and mainframe data over existing networks.

Quote of the Week

"Deep down in their hearts everyone hates Unix." — **Peter S. Kastner**, a VP and consultant at Aberdeen Group (see story, page 10).

is this you?